Matthew Russell Renfer

Senior Front-End Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Front-End Engineer with 15+ years in web development, owning production codebases from first request through launch and support for university, healthcare-staffing, and enterprise commerce sites. The last five years have centered on React/Next.js and headless CMS builds, instrumented with GA4 and Google Tag Manager to prove business impact. Works in AI-assisted workflows (Claude Code) to take projects from idea to production, reviewing and testing the code they produce. Turns stakeholder requests into accessible, performant features and owns them in production.

SKILLS

Front-End: React, Next.js, Vue.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Sass, Tailwind; state management (React state/Context, Redux)

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, agentic coding workflows, prompt and context design, reviewing and testing AI-generated code, taking projects from idea to production

CMS Platforms: Optimizely CMS, Contentful, WordPress (custom themes and plugins)

Analytics & Measurement: GA4, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, event tracking, conversion measurement, dashboarding

Performance, SEO & Accessibility: Lighthouse/PageSpeed Insights optimization, image optimization, caching, SEO-friendly routing and metadata, accessibility (WCAG guidelines, semantic HTML, keyboard navigation)

Integrations & Architecture: REST and GraphQL APIs, third-party API integration, reusable component libraries

Tooling & Deployment: Git/GitHub, CI/CD, AWS, Vercel, Cloudflare, Supabase (Postgres)

Collaboration: Agile development, cross-functional alignment, documentation, stakeholder communication

EXPERIENCE

Web Developer (Contract) Mar 2026 – Jul 2026

Yamaha Motor Corporation, USA — Kennesaw, GA

- Owned front-end feature work on a headless commerce platform (Next.js + Optimizely CMS), turning stakeholder requests into shipped features, including an enhancement surfacing accessory installation instructions via the Oracle Knowledge (OKA) API; reused existing Owner's Manuals infrastructure to ship faster and avoid duplicate work.
- Implemented GA4 and Google Tag Manager across customer-facing pages, standing up event tracking and conversion measurement that gave the team visibility into user behaviors it previously lacked.
- Built Looker Studio dashboards translating raw analytics into stakeholder-ready insight, tying front-end changes to business outcomes.
- Diagnosed and shipped a production hotfix on an ambiguous cross-stack issue, isolating it to the front end and restoring the site's purchase/checkout flow.

Technologies: Next.js, TypeScript, Optimizely CMS, GA4, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, Oracle Knowledge API, REST

Interface Engineer Jul 2021 – Jun 2025

Soltech — Atlanta, GA

- Served as lead front-end engineer on GaSSO, a Georgia state scholarship application built in React.
- Owned the SnapNurse-to-SnapCare rebrand as sole developer: built the new WordPress site from scratch within three weeks and launched the full rebrand in six; average monthly visits rose 25% in the four months after launch.
- Shipped GA4-instrumented landing pages and supported a new content and SEO strategy that grew organic traffic 23% quarter over quarter (Q1 to Q2 2024).

- Partnered with a solutions architect to implement performance improvements on a Vue 2 donation portal.
- Maintained and extended Soltech's flagship WordPress site, improving performance and searchability and reducing maintenance burden.
- Partnered with design, marketing, and backend teams to deliver performant, maintainable code; built reusable components and third-party API integrations that standardized design patterns and accelerated new project launches.

Technologies: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Vue.js, WordPress, Node, REST APIs, Docker, AWS, CI/CD

Senior Web Developer Sep 2020 – May 2021

Tactic Edge Solutions — Atlanta, GA

- Launched and maintained multiple WordPress-based marketing and application sites.
- Collaborated with product teams to develop new customer-facing features and improve user experience through design mock-ups and front-end enhancements.
- Implemented optimized WordPress themes and plugins to improve site performance and SEO visibility.
- Introduced UI refinements that increased client conversion rates and user engagement.

Senior Web Developer Dec 2015 – Sep 2020

Gardner-Webb University — Boiling Springs, NC

- Sole owner of the university's web codebase, translating requests from academic, administrative, and marketing stakeholders into shipped features as the university-wide web development lead.
- Delivered several website redesigns, migrations, and rebranding efforts, culminating in a custom WordPress theme still in use today.
- Managed the full project lifecycle, from requirements gathering through deployment, for new site sections, database-driven applications, and marketing campaigns.
- Launched redesigned enrollment landing pages that supported measurable growth in student applications.
- Ensured accessibility and performance compliance across university web properties.

Web Developer / Staff Writer Nov 2010 – Dec 2015

Gardner-Webb University — Boiling Springs, NC

Built and maintained gardner-webb.edu; trained staff on CMS/WordPress; supported enrollment web and alumni publications.

Web Developer Oct 2009 – Nov 2010

Image Marketing Group — NC

Built client web presences aligned to business goals; improved SEO and reduced support load.

PROJECTS

Handful — Personal Project 2025 – 2026

matthewrenfer.com/portfolio/handful

- Designed and built a client tracker end to end with AI-assisted workflows (Claude Code), from the interface down to the database; its front page headlines who needs you today.
- Secured each user's data at the database level with Supabase Row Level Security, so a bug in the interface can't expose another person's records.
- Kept the design system in one set of light and dark tokens, so the theme changes in one place.

Technologies: Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind 4, Supabase (Postgres and Auth), Vercel, Resend, Claude Code

EDUCATION & TRAINING

B.A., Professional Writing — Western Connecticut State University, 2008

Training: The Modern React Bootcamp · The Web Development Bootcamp · Become a WordPress Developer · User Experience Design Essentials · Structured Vibe Coding with AI Coding Agents. Certificates at matthewrenfer.com.